

25 DIY Home Projects That Save Money

Practical Upgrades and Repairs Anyone Can Do

Table of Contents

Introduction

The Basic DIY Toolbox

Category 1: Energy & Water Savers

Category 2: Quick Fixes & Repairs

Category 3: Organization & Upcycling

Category 4: Outdoor & Garden

Conclusion

Introduction

Welcome to "25 DIY Home Projects That Save Money." Home ownership and even renting can be expensive, but many of the most common costs—high utility bills, minor repairs, and clutter—can be solved with a little bit of time and very basic tools.

This book isn't about major renovations. It's about the **\$5 fix that saves \$50** on your monthly bill, or the 10-minute repair that prevents a \$200 plumber visit. Let's get to work!

The Basic DIY Toolbox

You don't need a workshop. Most of these projects can be done with:

- Multi-bit screwdriver (Flathead and Phillips)
- Hammer
- Tape measure
- Utility knife
- Adjustable wrench
- Needle-nose pliers
- Caulk gun
- Safety glasses

Category 1: Energy & Water Savers

1. Weatherstrip Your Doors

The Save: Reduces heating/cooling loss by 10-15%.

What You Need: Weatherstripping tape, scissors, measuring tape.

The Fix: Measure your door frame, cut weatherstripping to size, peel and stick along the frame where the door closes.

2. Install a Faucet Aerator

The Save: Reduces water usage by 30% without losing pressure.

What You Need: New aerator (universal size, \$3-5).

The Fix: Unscrew the old aerator from your faucet tip, screw on the new one.

3. Seal Window Gaps

The Save: Stops drafts and reduces heating/cooling bills.

What You Need: Caulk or rope caulk.

The Fix: Apply caulk to gaps between window frame and wall. For operable windows, use rope caulk that can be removed.

4. Install a Programmable Thermostat

The Save: Up to 10% on heating/cooling costs.

What You Need: Basic programmable thermostat, screwdriver.

The Fix: Turn off power to HVAC, label wires, remove old thermostat, mount new base, connect wires, attach faceplate.

5. Fix a Running Toilet

The Save: Saves up to \$50/month on water bills.

What You Need: Toilet flapper kit (\$8).

The Fix: Open tank, check if flapper is warped or chain is stuck. Replace flapper if necessary.

Category 2: Quick Fixes & Repairs

6. Unclog a Drain Without Chemicals

The Save: Avoids \$150 plumber visit.

What You Need: Plunger or drain snake.

The Fix: Remove stopper, use plunger in vigorous motion. For tough clogs, use a drain snake.

7. Patch a Small Hole in Drywall

The Save: Avoids \$100 handyman visit.

What You Need: Spackle, putty knife, sandpaper.

The Fix: Apply spackle with putty knife, let dry, sand smooth, paint.

8. Fix a Squeaky Door

The Save: Zero cost, 5-minute fix.

What You Need: WD-40 or cooking oil.

The Fix: Spray or dab oil onto hinges, open and close door to distribute.

9. Replace a Light Switch or Outlet Cover

The Save: Costs \$2, freshens whole room.

What You Need: New cover plate, screwdriver.

The Fix: Unscrew old cover, replace with new one, tighten screws.

10. Tighten Loose Cabinet Handles

The Save: Prevents damage to cabinet doors.

What You Need: Screwdriver.

The Fix: Tighten screws on the back of the handle. If stripped, use a longer screw or the toothpick trick.

Category 3: Organization & Upcycling

11. Create a Command Center Wall

The Save: Reduces paper clutter and late fees.

What You Need: Corkboard or magnetic board, hooks.

The Fix: Mount board on wall, add hooks for keys, use clips for mail.

12. DIY Under-Shelf Basket

The Save: Creates storage space for free.

What You Need: Wire basket, zip ties.

The Fix: Attach zip ties through basket holes and around shelf, tighten.

13. Magnetic Spice Rack

The Save: Frees up cabinet space.

What You Need: Magnetic strip, adhesive tape, small tins.

The Fix: Mount magnetic strip inside cabinet door, transfer spices to small metal tins.

14. Mason Jar Organizer

The Save: Reuses jars you already have.

What You Need: Mason jars, lid, screws.

The Fix: Screw jar lids to the underside of a shelf. Twist jars on.

15. Shoe Organizer for Cleaning Supplies

The Save: Repurposes an old organizer.

What You Need: Over-door shoe organizer.

The Fix: Hang on pantry or closet door, fill pockets with cleaning sprays and rags.

Category 4: Outdoor & Garden

16. Build a Rain Barrel

The Save: Free water for your garden.

What You Need: Large trash can, spigot, downspout diverter.

The Fix: Drill hole near bottom, install spigot. Place under downspout.

17. DIY Compost Bin

The Save: Free fertilizer, less trash.

What You Need: Wood pallets or plastic bin.

The Fix: Stack pallets into a 3-sided box. Or drill holes in a plastic bin.

18. Plant a Herb Garden

The Save: Saves \$3-5 per bunch at the store.

What You Need: Pots, soil, seeds or starters.

The Fix: Fill pots with soil, plant seeds/herbs, water, place in sunlight.

19. Clean Your Dryer Vent

The Save: Prevents fire risk and improves efficiency.

What You Need: Vacuum with hose attachment.

The Fix: Disconnect dryer from vent, vacuum inside vent opening and behind dryer, reconnect.

20. Power-Wash Patio or Deck

The Save: Extends life of outdoor surfaces.

What You Need: Power washer (rent for \$40/day).

The Fix: Spray away dirt and mildew.

Conclusion: You're Now a Home Hero

These 25 projects prove that you don't need a handyman or a big budget to maintain and improve your home. Start with the project that will save you the most money this month, and build your confidence from there. Every fix you do yourself is money in your pocket!